[1] Rachida was born in a rural Moroccan village, Ain Jdid, in 1973. She is married and has four children. Her husband is a seasonal agricultural worker who earns about 700 Dhs per month when he works.

[2] When an aid organization offered literacy classes in her village, Rachida immediately recognized that an excellent opportunity was suddenly offered to her. The class signaled a new beginning for Rachida — if she took classes, she would be able to read and write, add and subtract, and acquire skills that were always reserved for others. When she first learned how to write her name on a slate, and then on paper, she was overjoyed. Although Rachida and her classmates were laughed at by some villagers as **they** walked to school each day, they ignored **them** and were proud of their accomplishments.

[3] The course went a step beyond providing basic literacy training to the women of Ain Jdid. Those who performed the best on the final exam were also offered support in setting up a business. a farm animal cooperative. Armed with their newly acquired numeracy and literacy skills, and with technical assistance from the organization, they started a successful business. Their example gave rural women a new image -that of independent female entrepreneurs who could manage their own businesses. They were no longer field workers. Rachida now buys and sells farm animals through the cooperative and earns enough income to support her family. More importantly, she can share the joy of learning with her school-aged children and help them with their homework. She is confident about the future. She says her new skills have given her more than just an income. "Through this program, women have paved the way to a new life," she said.

[4] As a proof to the program's success, now even some of the men in the village who had criticized Rachida and her classmates want to attend literacy classes.

I. COMPREHENSION (15 points)

BASE ALL YOUR ANSWERS ON THE TEXT

A. ARE THESE SENTENCES TRUE OR FALSE? JUSTIFY (3 pts)

1. Rachida is originally from a big city.

……

2. Some villagers made fun of women going to literacy classes.

……

3. Some women of the village became independent.

……

B. ANSWER THESE QUESTIONS IN YOUR OWN WORDS. (4 pts)

1. What opportunities did literacy classes offer to Rachida?

……

2. Which group of women benefited from technical assistance?

……

3. How do Rachida and children benefit from her literacy?

……

4. Why did some villagers change their opinion about the literacy program?

……

C. WHAT DO THE UNDERLINED WORDS IN THE TEXT REFER TO? (2 pts)

1. They: ……

2. them: ……

D. FIND IN THE TEXT WORDS OR EXPRESSIONS THAT MEAN THE SAME AS (4 pts)

1. Periodical (Paragraph. 1): ……

2. Very happy (Paragraph. 2): ……

3. Starting (Paragraph. 3): ……

4. Money (Paragraph. 4): ……

E. WHICH OF THE FOLLOWING WOULD BE THE BEST TITLE FOR THE PASSAGE? (2 pts)

1. Female entrepreneurs change rural men's life.

2. Literacy changes a rural woman's life.

3. Rural men change rural women's life

The best title is: ……

KEY AND MARKING SCALE

Accept any appropriate answer not mentioned in this key.

I. COMPREHENSION (15 POINTS)

Testees should not be penalised for spelling or grammar mistakes in the comprehension section.

TRUE / FALSE: (3 pts)

1. **False.** "Rachida was born in a rural Moroccan village, Ain Jdid" (paragraph 1)
2. **True.** "Rachida and her classmates were laughed at by some villagers" (paragraph 2)
3. **True.** They became "independent female entrepreneurs who could manage their own businesses". (paragraph 3)

WH QUESTIONS: (4 pts)

1. They allowed her to read and write, add and subtract, and acquire new skills; they were a new beginning and led to setting up a business.
2. The women who performed best on the final exam.
3. She can share the joy of learning with her children and help them with their homework (and she earns an income to support them).
4. Because of the success of the program (women changed their lives and became independent).

WORD REFERENCE: (2 pts) 1. Rachida and her classmates 2. (Some) villagers

RIGHT WORD MEANING: (4 pts)

1. seasonal
2. overjoyed
3. setting up
4. income (note: the word "income" is in paragraph 3 of the text)

CHOOSE THE CORRECT OPTION: (2 pts) 2. Literacy changes a rural woman's life.